

MASTER ACCEPTABLE USE AND LABORATORY SECURITY POLICY

Institutional Endpoint Security, Data Governance, and Laboratory Access Framework

Effective Date: May 26, 2026

Governing Jurisdiction: Katihar, Bihar, India

Regulatory Alignment: Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023

Adoption Note

This document establishes the conditions under which institutional computer laboratory resources may be accessed, evaluated, and protected.

Version 1.0

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1. Purpose, Scope, and Governing Principles

The Institution provides physical computer laboratory infrastructure, including desktops, peripherals, local storage, attached accessories, and network access points, for the purpose of supporting structured technical education, supervised exercises, examinations, demonstrations, and related academic activity. These assets are state-owned or institution-controlled resources and must be handled as shared academic property, not as personal devices.

This Policy establishes the operational terms governing the use of those resources. It is intended to preserve the integrity of the laboratory environment, protect institutional systems from malware and unauthorized access, maintain exam fairness, reduce accidental damage, and ensure that all processing of student-related data occurs within a defined governance framework.

The Policy is designed to function as an enforceable institutional standard. It applies to all students, guardians to the extent of consent and acknowledgment, faculty members supervising laboratory use, administrators overseeing endpoint security, and any other person authorized to operate within the laboratory environment.

Nothing in this document should be read to permit uncontrolled access, device modification, policy circumvention, or unilateral changes to the security architecture. Because a single compromised endpoint can affect connected systems, the Institution applies a uniform baseline configuration across the laboratory environment.

This document shall be interpreted in a manner consistent with institutional safety, academic fairness, good-faith implementation, and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, as applicable to the Institution's role and obligations.

2. Definitions and Interpretation

- Institution means the school, laboratory authority, or other educational body administering the equipment and evaluation process.
- Endpoint means any approved laboratory computer, terminal, workstation, or related operating device supplied for academic use.
- Guardian means a parent, legal guardian, or authorized responsible adult signing on behalf of a minor student.
- Track A means the Digital Applied Track, in which practical work is performed on secured endpoints under the standard operational framework.
- Track B means the Offline Theoretical Track, in which practical work is completed through written, paper-based, or equivalent offline assessment.
- Nexus Sentinel means the institutional security and compliance utility described in this Policy, including its event-handling, policy-enforcement, and protection functions.
- Telemetry means security-relevant event data generated by the endpoint environment for detection, prevention, and review purposes.
- Human Review means assessment by a designated administrator, teacher, or authorized official before irreversible disciplinary or academic action is taken.

Headings are for convenience only and do not limit the meaning of the provisions that follow. Where this Policy uses the words 'may', 'must', 'shall', 'is permitted', or 'is prohibited', they are to be interpreted according to ordinary institutional compliance usage rather than casual speech. Human beings do love pretending words are flexible until a consequence arrives.

3. Institutional Infrastructure and Security Baseline

The laboratory environment is configured with a standardized operating-system baseline intended to preserve functionality, maintain evidence integrity, and prevent tampering. Security services, device controls, configuration enforcement, and other protective components may be integrated at the operating-system level or through equivalent administrative controls.

The Institution may maintain local administrative rights, device restrictions, application allowlists, removable media controls, account policies, and network safeguards in order to prevent unauthorized escalation, data exfiltration, or disruption of learning services. Individual users do not acquire ownership rights over these controls by virtue of temporary access.

A uniform baseline is necessary because the educational function of the laboratory depends on predictable and stable operation. Allowing one device or one account to behave as an exception would expose all other users to avoidable risk. The policy therefore treats consistency as a security requirement, not a convenience.

The Institution may update its baseline configuration from time to time to respond to new threats, revised pedagogy, or technical change. Such updates may include application updates, policy refreshes, signature changes, or control adjustments, provided they remain within the ordinary scope of institutional administration.

4. Nexus Sentinel Deployment and Operating Rules

All institutional endpoints are equipped with Nexus Sentinel, a proprietary Win32-native institutional security and compliance utility. Its functions are limited to cybersecurity, compliance enforcement, protection of institutional assets, and support for fair academic operation.

The software is not intended to function as a general consumer surveillance product. Its deployment is structured around security-minimization principles, with a preference for narrowly scoped local processing rather than indiscriminate collection. Data captured for security purposes must remain limited to what is reasonably necessary to assess risk, detect misuse, or preserve evidence of a serious incident.

The deployment shall not include any undocumented remote-view backdoor, persistent keystroke retention during ordinary use, or continuous live-screen monitoring outside a formally justified and authorized security process. If a critical escalation condition exists, the minimum necessary event record may be generated, encrypted, and stored or transmitted in accordance with the Institution's governance practices.

Students and guardians should understand that a security utility embedded at the endpoint level cannot be separately disabled for one user without undermining the entire protective model. The Institution therefore requires a single, coherent baseline for all users of the same laboratory resources.

Nexus Sentinel may be updated, patched, reconfigured, or replaced by the Institution or its authorized vendor in response to security threats, compatibility changes, or legal obligations. Such updates do not alter the basic obligation of users to comply with the laboratory security environment.

5. Permitted Use of Laboratory Resources

Permitted use includes classroom exercises, guided practical work, supervised experimentation, approved software development tasks, sanctioned data handling, and other academic activities expressly assigned or authorized by the Institution.

Users must log in only with assigned credentials, use only approved accounts where required, save work in designated locations, and preserve the integrity of files, folders, and settings belonging to the Institution or

other students. Shared environments remain shared, not communal in the sense of everyone doing whatever they feel like because that has historically ended beautifully.

Reasonable temporary deviation from the default workflow is permitted only when expressly required by curriculum instructions, instructor direction, or documented accessibility accommodation. Even then, users remain bound by all security and academic integrity obligations.

The Institution may permit approved classroom software, compilers, development environments, browsers, productivity tools, and peripheral devices if they are consistent with the course objective and do not threaten system integrity. Authorization may be general or activity-specific and may be withdrawn if misuse is detected.

6. Prohibited Conduct and Category-Based Infractions

The following conduct is prohibited unless specifically authorized in writing by the Institution or expressly permitted under a supervised teaching activity:

- Installing or attempting to install malware, unwanted utilities, cracked software, unauthorized remote access tools, or persistence mechanisms.
- Attempting to bypass authentication, elevate privileges, disable security controls, alter boot settings, or tamper with system files.
- Using proxy evasion tools, tunneling software, network bypass utilities, or similar mechanisms to evade institutional filtering or monitoring.
- Interfering with examinations, submitting work on behalf of another person, or using tools intended to facilitate dishonesty or unauthorized assistance.
- Copying, modifying, deleting, or exfiltrating files belonging to the Institution, the instructor, or another student without approval.
- Accessing explicit adult content on institutional systems where such access is associated with policy breach, safeguarding concern, or unauthorized use.
- Connecting unapproved storage devices, peripherals, or network equipment that could weaken security or import risk.

For Track A users, serious violations may be categorized as Category A Infractions. Classification does not by itself determine guilt or penalty. It identifies events that warrant review because they may indicate malware, credential compromise, unauthorized access, or intentional misuse.

Exceptions may be made for legitimate cybersecurity learning, debugging, or approved technical experimentation, but only where the activity is explicitly assigned or authorized and remains within the limits established by the instructor and the Institution.

7. Monitoring, Telemetry, and Event Handling

The Institution may collect security-relevant telemetry from endpoints for the limited purpose of detecting threats, enforcing policy, supporting incident response, and preserving evidence where necessary. Telemetry may include event timestamps, process metadata, policy state changes, integrity alerts, and other narrowly scoped indicators.

Routine educational use is not intended to be continuously observed by human operators. Automated alerts should be treated as triggers for review, not as final judgments. This distinction matters, apparently, because systems can be excellent at noticing anomalies and mediocre at understanding context.

Where telemetry suggests a serious security event, the alert must be reviewed by a human administrator before any irreversible academic penalty or disciplinary action is imposed. Human Review should consider the nature

of the alert, the surrounding circumstances, the user's explanation, and any available corroborating information.

If the Institution determines that a device or account is under active compromise, it may temporarily isolate the endpoint, suspend access, disable a session, or preserve relevant logs to protect the broader environment. Such actions are preventive and administrative, not a declaration of misconduct by themselves.

Users should not attempt to suppress, interfere with, or retaliate against security alerts, logs, or administrative review. The proper response to an alert is cooperation, not improvisation.

8. Data Governance, Minimization, and Retention

The Institution acts as the Data Fiduciary for data processed in the course of administering the laboratory environment, while any software provider or technical vendor acts as a Data Processor to the extent of contracted processing. Data handling shall follow the principles of purpose limitation, minimization, confidentiality, and security.

Processing should be limited to what is reasonably necessary for device security, academic continuity, and fairness of evaluation. The Institution will not deliberately expand data collection beyond those ends without a lawful basis, a documented institutional purpose, and any additional notice or consent required by applicable law.

Security records should be retained only for as long as reasonably necessary to support audit, investigation, compliance, dispute resolution, or statutory obligations. After the relevant retention period, such records should be deleted, anonymized, or archived according to the Institution's record-management policy.

Students and guardians acknowledge that some processing is inseparable from the operation of secured endpoints. Refusing all processing while demanding uninterrupted endpoint access is a logical contradiction, one of humanity's quieter hobbies.

9. Academic Access Tracks and Evaluation Structure

To preserve academic parity while respecting the different technological choices available to guardians, the Institution offers two parallel evaluation tracks. Both tracks are recognized as legitimate academic pathways, though the method of assessment will differ.

Track A is the Digital Applied Track. It is intended for students who use the secured endpoint environment to complete practical coursework and examinations in a supervised digital setting. Track A allows direct interaction with development tools and digital resources under the institution's security controls.

Track B is the Offline Theoretical Track. It is intended for students whose guardians choose not to consent to the Digital Applied Track or who later revoke such consent. Track B substitutes paper-based and manual assessment methods for live endpoint usage.

Both tracks should measure the same academic objectives to the extent practicable, including conceptual understanding, procedural reasoning, system design awareness, and problem-solving ability. The Institution may adapt the form of assessment, but not the underlying instructional purpose.

Time limits, examination standards, and grading expectations may be aligned across both tracks so that neither group gains an unfair advantage through extended access, unrestricted tool support, or reduced rigor.

10. Track A Procedures and Incident Review

Students in Track A will use institutional endpoints for classroom and assessment work, subject to the installed security baseline and all applicable supervision requirements. Work may be monitored by automated security controls and by classroom staff where needed.

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Where an alert, anomaly, or suspected infraction occurs, the Institution should document the event, preserve the relevant context, and conduct Human Review before any major consequence is applied. Review should distinguish malicious conduct from accidental triggers, curriculum-related experimentation, or misconfiguration.

If the event concerns malware, unauthorized privilege escalation, credential theft, cheating tools, or network bypass activity, the Institution may temporarily restrict access pending investigation. The restriction should be proportionate to the risk and lifted when the matter has been resolved.

Students may be asked to provide a written explanation, demonstrate understanding, or repeat an exercise under supervision. An institution that cares about learning will test judgment as well as output, though some people seem to think a keyboard is a magic truth machine.

11. Track B Procedures and Manual Assessment

Students in Track B shall complete practical coursework and examinations in an offline format, using paper, permitted calculators if any, diagrams, and written explanations as specified by the Institution.

Track B assessments may include raw syntax drafting, flowchart construction, algorithm tracing, pseudocode, data-flow documentation, manual calculation of spreadsheet expressions, and other paper-based representations of technical understanding. The point is not to mimic software execution perfectly. The point is to reveal whether the student actually understands what the software is doing instead of relying on the software to perform the thinking.

The Institution may evaluate syntax accuracy, logical sequencing, architectural understanding, notation discipline, and completeness. Minor errors may be deducted according to the published rubric, while major conceptual omissions may carry greater weight.

Track B does not permit access to live compilers, online debugging aids, search tools, or live code execution during the assessed activity unless specifically authorized for that exercise. The absence of those tools is part of the assessment design.

The Institution may use standardized prompts, model answers, or common rubrics so that Track B remains administratively fair and educationally coherent across students and academic terms.

12. Roles, Responsibilities, and Supervision

Students must follow instructions, respect laboratory equipment, and report irregular behavior, suspicious pop-ups, unexpected account changes, or device damage to the supervising staff promptly.

Guardians are responsible for reviewing the Policy, deciding which track to authorize, and understanding the educational and technical implications of that choice. A signature is not a decorative squiggle; it is a choice carrying consequences, which is inconvenient but apparently necessary.

Teachers and administrators are responsible for enforcing the Policy consistently, documenting incidents, preserving confidentiality, and escalating matters in accordance with institutional procedure.

Technical staff are responsible for maintaining the endpoint baseline, applying updates, managing logs, and responding to security incidents with restraint, competence, and proper change control.

The Institution may delegate particular operational tasks to authorized staff or external vendors, but accountability for governance remains with the Institution.

13. Enforcement, Appeals, and Due Process

The Institution may apply graduated responses to policy violations, including counseling, written warnings, temporary suspension of access, device isolation, assignment rework, disciplinary referral, or other proportionate measures permitted under institutional rules.

Before a severe or irreversible measure is imposed, the student should have an opportunity for explanation and review unless immediate action is necessary to prevent ongoing harm. Where circumstances permit, the Institution should document the basis for its decision and retain the relevant evidence.

A student or guardian may request reconsideration of a decision in accordance with the Institution's internal grievance process. The request should identify the incident, the alleged error, and any supporting explanation or materials.

Appeal rights do not permit endless argument as a substitute for compliance. A review process exists to correct mistakes, not to turn every policy enforcement into a constitutional opera.

14. Consent, Revocation, Transfer, and Continuity

Consent to Track A is voluntarily provided by the guardian or eligible student, as applicable, and may be revoked at any time through a written notice or equivalent approved method.

If consent is revoked during an academic term, the student will be transitioned to Track B for the remaining evaluation period, subject to scheduling and administrative practicality. The Institution may use a reasonable transition period if needed to preserve fairness and continuity.

A student on Track B may transition to Track A upon submission of the signed acknowledgment and completion of any onboarding or technical requirements the Institution considers necessary.

The Institution may maintain continuity of coursework through equivalent learning outcomes, substitution assignments, or comparable practical tasks, provided that such measures do not dilute the academic standard or compromise security.

15. Limitation of Liability and Educational Risk Allocation

The Institution is responsible for maintaining the secure deployment of its laboratory environment and for acting in good faith when enforcing this Policy. However, the Institution is not liable for academic performance issues arising from a student's failure to complete required written logic, manual diagrams, syntax drafting, or other Track B obligations in accordance with the rubric.

The student and guardian acknowledge that selecting a track carries educational consequences. A secure laboratory is not the same thing as a limitless sandbox, and a paper-based assessment is not the same thing as a live coding environment. Astonishing, really.

Nothing in this Policy excludes any liability that cannot be excluded under applicable law. All other liability, to the extent permitted, is limited by the Institution's statutory and internal governance framework.

16. Final Acknowledgment

By signing this document, the student and parent or guardian confirm that they have read, understood, and agreed to the Master Acceptable Use and Laboratory Security Policy, including the selected evaluation track and all related security and academic terms.

This acknowledgment applies to the current academic term and remains effective until replaced, revoked, superseded, or renewed in accordance with institutional procedure.

Annex A. Security Infraction Catalog

The following examples are provided to clarify the types of events that may be treated as serious security concerns under Track A.

- Malware installation, execution, or staged deployment.
- Unauthorized persistence, scheduled task manipulation, or startup hijacking.
- Attempts to escalate privileges, inject code, alter system protections, or bypass security layers.
- Credential harvesting, keylogging attempts, or unauthorized access to another user's session.
- Use of anonymous routing, proxy bypass, tunneling, or similar evasion tools on restricted networks.
- Tampering with logs, audit records, device identifiers, or monitoring controls.
- Subverting exam integrity through hidden assistance, unauthorized scripts, or protected content leakage.
- Distribution of unapproved files that compromise security or violate institutional policy.

This catalog is illustrative rather than exhaustive. The Institution may identify analogous conduct as a comparable infraction if the security effect is substantially the same.

Annex B. Manual Evaluation Rubric

Track B assessments should be graded using a transparent rubric aligned to the course objective. The following criteria may be used as a baseline.

Criterion	What Is Measured	Typical Evidence
Conceptual accuracy	Whether the student understands the underlying idea or process	Correct explanation, labeled diagram, sound reasoning
Syntax discipline	Whether raw code or notation is written in a valid and coherent form	Accurate keywords, proper order, complete expressions
Algorithmic logic	Whether the sequence of steps is correct and complete	Flowchart, pseudocode, stepwise reasoning
Data handling	Whether calculations and transformations are performed correctly	Manual formula evaluation, trace tables, worked solutions
System architecture	Whether the student can describe components and relationships	Component map, input/output flow, dependency diagram

Deduction rules may mirror the effect of a compiler or validation system where appropriate, subject to pedagogical fairness. The purpose is to assess whether the student can produce a technically sound answer without the assistance of live tooling.

Annex C. Student and Guardian Acknowledgment

Please review, complete, and sign the acknowledgment below.

Student Name	_____
Student Roll / ID Number	_____
Parent / Guardian Name	_____
Selected Track	☐ Track A ☐ Track B
Parent / Guardian Signature	_____
Date	_____

The Institution may retain this signed acknowledgment as part of its academic and compliance records.

Annex D. Standard Operating Workflow

The following workflow describes the ordinary sequence of use for Track A students and staff. It is intended to reduce ambiguity, preserve consistency, and make routine actions administratively traceable.

- User signs in with assigned credentials and confirms the correct account profile.
- The supervising teacher confirms the activity, lesson objective, and permitted tools.
- The student performs the assigned work using approved software and storage locations.
- If a warning or policy prompt appears, the student pauses work and informs the supervisor.
- If the event is technical rather than disciplinary, the supervisor may reset the session, reapply policy, or escalate to technical staff.
- Completed work is saved, submitted, or printed in accordance with classroom instructions.
- The session is closed, any removable media is removed, and the endpoint is returned to its default state.

This workflow is deliberately ordinary. Institutions generally prefer ordinary because chaos is expensive and surprisingly bad for exam results.

The Institution may adapt the workflow where accessibility support, special examination conditions, or maintenance requirements demand a modified sequence. Any such variation should preserve the central security and integrity objectives of the Policy.

Workflow Stage	Responsible Party	Key Output
Pre-session setup	Teacher or administrator	Verified room, accounts, and allowed tools
Active use	Student	Completed assignment under supervision
Alert handling	Supervisor and technical staff	Documented review and response
Session closure	Student and staff	Saved work and clean endpoint state

Annex E. Retention, Escalation, and Record Handling

Security and compliance records should be managed according to a simple principle: keep what is necessary, do not keep what is not, and do not pretend every log line deserves a permanent shrine.

Records may include incident summaries, review notes, access control changes, class-specific authorization records, consent forms, and retention notices. These records should be protected against unauthorized access and reviewed only by personnel with a legitimate need to know.

Where a serious incident occurs, the Institution may create a temporary escalation file containing the minimum necessary facts for investigation and remediation. That file should be merged into the normal record structure or closed when the matter is resolved.

- Routine instructional records: retained for the normal academic cycle or as required by institutional policy.
- Security alerts requiring review: retained until review is complete and any dispute period has ended.
- Confirmed incidents involving abuse or damage: retained for audit, disciplinary, or legal purposes subject to applicable law.
- Revoked or withdrawn consent documents: retained only as needed to show that a valid governance decision occurred.

Access to retained records should be role-based. Staff members who do not administer security or academics should not routinely access sensitive logs. The more people can read a record, the less private it tends to become, which is a recurring lesson humans somehow still need.

The Institution may anonymize, aggregate, or otherwise transform records when the operational purpose can be satisfied without keeping direct identifiers.

Annex F. Receipt, Confirmation, and Renewal Notice

This annex may be issued to students and guardians as a formal receipt of policy distribution and choice of evaluation track. It may also be used during renewal at the start of a new academic term.

By signing, the guardian confirms the following:

- The Policy was made available for review before enrollment in the selected track.
- The guardian understands that Track A uses a secured endpoint environment with institutional controls.
- The guardian understands that Track B substitutes manual, offline assessment methods for live endpoint use.
- The guardian accepts that academic expectations remain substantive in both tracks.
- The guardian understands that consent may be revoked and that a transition to the alternate track may occur.

The Institution may require a fresh acknowledgment when policy language changes materially, when the evaluation structure is revised, or when the student enters a new academic cycle.

Final Sign-Off and Administrative Entry

Institutional Representative: _____

Designation: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Seal / Stamp: _____

Guardian Confirmation: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Student Confirmation: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Administrative Record Number: _____

This document is intended to be retained with the student file and the laboratory governance register.